

USA MISSIONARIES

God Established the Sabbath

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Genesis 2:2-3** By the seventh day God had finished the work He had been doing; so on the seventh day He rested... Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy...
- **Exodus 20:8-10** Remember the Sabbath day by keeping it holy...

KEY IDEA

- The Sabbath was established at creation before the Law.
- God rested not because He was tired, but to set a pattern.
- The Sabbath is a gift, not a burden.
- It is holy time set apart for rest and worship.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Why did God model rest if He does not grow weary?
2. What does it mean to call a day holy?
3. Do you see Sabbath as a gift or an obligation?

The Purpose of the Sabbath

KEY SCRIPTURES

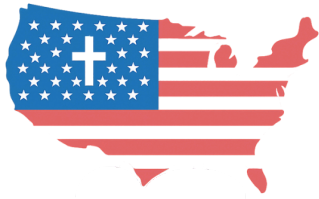
- **Exodus 31:13** It will be a sign between Me and you...
- **Deuteronomy 5:15** Remember that you were slaves in Egypt... Therefore the Lord has commanded you to observe the Sabbath day.
- **Mark 2:27** The Sabbath was made for man, not man for the Sabbath.

KEY IDEA

- The Sabbath reminds us:
 - God is Creator.
 - God is Deliverer.
 - We are not slaves.
 - It is a weekly declaration that we trust God more than our productivity.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What does your schedule say about what you trust?
2. Do you rest as someone who has been set free?
3. Is your identity rooted in work or in being God's child?



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Jesus and the Sabbath

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Mark 2:28** The Son of Man is Lord even of the Sabbath.
- **Luke 4:16** ...on the Sabbath day He went into the synagogue, as was his custom.
- **Matthew 11:28** Come to Me, all you who are weary...

KEY IDEA

- Jesus did not abolish the Sabbath.
- He corrected legalism around it.
- He demonstrated that the Sabbath is about mercy, restoration, and relationship.
- True Sabbath rest is ultimately found in Christ.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. How did Jesus confront misuse of the Sabbath?
2. What is the difference between rest and laziness?
3. Are you experiencing rest in Christ or just taking time off?

Sabbath in the Life of the Believer

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Hebrews 4:9-10** There remains, then, a Sabbath rest for the people of God...
- **Acts 2:42** They devoted themselves to the apostles' teaching and to fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

KEY IDEA

- The early believers gathered consistently.
- They devoted time to worship, teaching, fellowship, and prayer.
- The Sabbath rhythm includes:
 - Ceasing from normal work.
 - Gathering with believers.
 - Worship and Scripture.
 - Delight in God and family.
 - It is intentional time to realign the heart.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Do you have a weekly rhythm of worship and rest?
2. What would need to change in your life to honor a Sabbath rhythm?
3. How would your family be impacted by a protected day of rest?



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Sabbath in the Life of the Believer (Cont.)

KEY SCRIPTURES

- **Psalms 46:10** Be still, and know that I am God.
- **Matthew 6:33** But seek first His kingdom and His righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. What keeps me from slowing down?
2. Do I secretly believe everything depends on me?
3. Where is God inviting me to trust Him more?

PRACTICAL SABBATH PLAN

- Choose a consistent day each week.
- Cease from normal work and productivity.
- Gather with believers for worship.
- Spend extended time in Scripture and prayer.
- Enjoy God's gifts without distraction.
- Protect the day intentionally.

PERSONAL ACTION QUESTIONS

1. What day will I set apart?
2. What work will I intentionally stop doing?
3. How will I center this day around worship?
4. What distractions need to be removed?

PRAYER

Dear Heavenly Father, You are my Provider and Sustainer. Teach me to rest in You. Free me from striving and self reliance. Help me honor holy time and trust You with my work. Let my Sabbath be a weekly declaration that You are Lord. Amen.